



iPhone 11 Pro defies all odds

An iPhone 11 Pro reportedly survived 30 days stuck at the bottom of an icy lake. <http://digit.in/apr21-41>



Microsoft Discord

Microsoft is reportedly now in 'exclusive' talks to acquire Discord and the deal could close next month. <http://digit.in/apr21-42>

Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro

Samsung's best TWS yet

Samsung's foray into the truly wireless earbuds market has been a bit of a hit and miss.

The hit being the excellent Samsung Galaxy Buds Plus, and the miss being the Samsung Galaxy Buds Live, primarily due to its polarising bean-shaped buds. The company launched the Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro with its S21 lineup of 2021, and the company seems to have moved on from its bean-shaped folly and have adopted a more traditional in-ear design. Priced at ₹15,999, let's find out if the Galaxy Buds Pro are a worthy premium TWS option to consider.

BUILD AND COMFORT

The Galaxy Buds Pro feel like a mashup between the Galaxy Buds Plus and the Galaxy Buds Live with it borrowing the glossy metallic look and the clamshell charging case design of the Buds Live and the in-ear form factor of the Buds Plus. The in-ear fit should seal most ears securely but those with smaller ears might find it harder to get the perfect fit. Samsung has also thrown in IPX7 water resistance, so they should be able to shrug off splashes and sweat easily. Moving on to the case, it has a clamshell design similar to the Galaxy Buds Live. The case also supports Qi Wireless Charging.

GALAXY WEARABLE APP, ANC, AND OTHER FEATURES

The Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro use the Galaxy Wearable app to access many of its features. The app allows users to tweak noise cancelling levels, customise a few touch controls, try out different EQ settings, activate 360 audio, and more. Now, most premium true wireless earbuds also customisable touch controls but Samsung has limited this to the 'Touch-and-hold' command only. This means users cannot play around with other commands. The Galaxy Wearable app also



offers 360 Audio, which creates a virtual surround sound environment with Dolby head tracking support. It's a pretty cool feature, but unfortunately, it is only available on Samsung devices. As for the app itself, the Galaxy Wearable app is available for Android devices. The Galaxy Buds app on iOS, on the other hand, doesn't have support for the Galaxy Buds Pro at the time of writing. So, iOS users will be able to use the buds only at default settings at the moment.

One of the most eye-catching features on the Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro is, of course, Active Noise Cancellation. ANC on this device is pretty decent. Three built-in microphones on the inside do a good job at mitigating most low-end, constant sounds such as an AC drone. However, it isn't as sophisticated as the Sony WF-1000XM3's ANC.

The Galaxy Buds Pro come with touch controls. The touch panel is sensitive and activates even unintentionally at times, which can get aggravating.

PERFORMANCE

The Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro is designed for Samsung users. Apart from SBC and AAC codecs, the device also supports Samsung's Scalable Bluetooth codec that is compatible

with Samsung smartphones, so you will get better sound when you use the buds with a compatible Samsung device. The Scalable codec improves both audio quality and connection stability and the difference is easily felt. We were pleasantly taken back by the natural and open sound using this codec. Instruments sounded lively, the soundstage was spacious and vocals were clear and detail-packed. When we switched over to another device that used the AAC codec, the sound was definitely more flat and uninspiring, but still good in this price range.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life on the Galaxy Buds Pro is mediocre. It is disappointing that we get a total battery life of only 18 hours. In our tests, with ANC turned on and the volume set to about 60 per cent, we got 16 hours of total usage and about 4 hours on the buds alone.

VERDICT

If you're a Samsung user, there's no reason why you shouldn't buy these buds. They're Samsung's best truly wireless earbuds yet with a great fit, amazing sound quality with the Scalable Bluetooth codec, an array of premium features, and a good accompanying app. However, if you're not a Samsung user, you won't get the best sound quality possible since you will be relegated to using the AAC or SBC codec and you will not be able to utilise some features such as 360 Audio, Dolby Head Tracking, and others.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

SPEAKER: 2 way (11mm Woofer & 6.5mm Tweeter) | **MIC:** Main Mic (High SNR), Sub Mic, Inner Mic | **CONNECTIVITY:** Bluetooth 5.0 | **CODECS:** Scalable (Samsung proprietary), AAC, SBC | **BATTERY LIFE:** 5h / total 18h (ANC ON), 8h / total 28h (ANC OFF) | **COLOURS:** Phantom Purple, Phantom Silver, Phantom Violet | **EARBUD WEIGHT:** 6.3g | **CASE WEIGHT:** 44.9g | **CHIPSET:** BCM 43015 | **OS:** RTOS

CONTACT

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